

CPU (Central Processor Unit)

The brains of your computer defines the speed which Linux will run at. Linux was originally devised on an Intel 386 back in the early 90's, and believe it or not, it will still work on a 386! It is worthy to note that Linux is a truly cross-platform system. A [Mac](#) computer (PPC or Intel) can run Linux, You can even run Linux on some stranger hardware including ARM based machines like Raspberry Pi's and more. Today's Linux desktop is most popular on 64 bit (x64) Intel or AMD PPC (G3-G5) and AMD processors, therefore, most of the common software is actively developed for these platforms. If you have another platform such as a Sparc, Amiga or ARM based processor, Linux will no doubt be different in that many software titles may not exist for that given platform, or software is older than that of the most popular platforms, but it is still possible to run Linux on them.

- Minimum Specification: 2GHz Intel Pentium 4/AMD K6, ideally with a dual-core processor. It is possible to run Linux on even more modest hardware, however the desktop experience will be limited.
- Recommended Specification: Intel Core i5/AMD A10 or better.